

Lab 04 — Connect Google Drive

Topic 02 · Tools and Skills

Meridian Capital Partners Pte Ltd — all data in this lab is synthetic and for training only.

Goal

Meridian's finance data does not live on your laptop — it sits in a shared Google Drive folder. You upload the firm's wider finance files to Drive, enable the Google Drive connector, and confirm Claude can read them without you attaching anything by hand.

You'll build

A working Google Drive connection scoped to the Meridian finance folder.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Google Drive connector

Mock data

The files for this lab are in `mock-data/`:

- `meridian-client-list.csv`
- `meridian-desk-targets-fy2025.csv`
- `meridian-quarterly-workbook-fy2025.csv`

Leave these files unchanged — let Claude write its output elsewhere.

The prompt

Copy this into Claude (it is also in `PROMPT.md`):

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Using the Google Drive connector, open the folder "Meridian Finance" in my Drive and tell me what you find.

For each file, give me:

- The file name and what kind of data it holds.
- The period it covers.
- The three figures you would use in a quarterly revenue summary.

Do not change, move or delete anything — read only.

List anything that looks inconsistent between the files.

Note: Claude asks for approval before it moves, shares or deletes a Drive file.

Steps

1. Upload the lab's mock-data files to a new Google Drive folder named Meridian Finance.

The lab supplies the quarterly workbook, the desk targets and the client list as mock data.

2. In Claude, click the plus sign in the composer and hover over Connectors.

This is where you turn individual connectors on and off for your account.

3. Toggle Google Drive on and sign in to your Google account.

On a Team or Enterprise plan an owner must enable connectors for the organisation first.

4. Approve the permissions Google asks for — grant FULL READ access.

Approve only what you are willing to let Claude reach. But if you decline the read scopes here, Claude connects yet cannot open anything.

5. If Claude reports an "insufficient scope" error, reconnect the connector.

Settings → Connectors → Google Drive → Reconnect, and accept the read permissions. A connector can show "Connected" while still missing the drive.readonly scope it needs to search and read files.

6. Paste the lab prompt so Claude reads the Meridian Finance folder.

Naming the folder scopes the task; Claude does not need access to your whole Drive.

7. Compare Claude's file summary against what you actually uploaded.

Confirm it found every file and read the right periods before you rely on it.

8. Note any inconsistency Claude reports between the files.

The Q4 Advisory target deliberately disagrees between two files — a real check.

Check your work

Claude lists all three Meridian Finance files with their periods, reports FY2025 revenue of S\$24,850,000, and flags that the Q4 Advisory target disagrees between the two files — S\$2,320,000 in the targets file against S\$2,410,000 in the workbook. Nothing in Drive has been changed.

Before you move on

Use only the supplied mock data and your own test accounts. Never put real client, personal or confidential data into a training exercise, and send lab emails to yourself rather than to a real recipient.